

what would happen to us in case we were to lose our jobs. Our children were definitely a priority for us, and we would be surely worried about them if we were to lose our jobs today.

Giving in to family needs, my wife took a bold step and quit her job to take care of our children. Our family was now dependent on my single source of income. The more I grew in my career, the more unstable the entire system holding our personal and professional life became. As time passed by and I kept rising in my career, I knew that something else was growing with the same momentum, if not quicker, and that was the fear of falling down. Just like a pack of cards.

My job was taking up a major part of my time and my life. It was becoming a higher priority, greater than my spouse, my children, my parents and even myself. I have been part of many coffee table discussions, during my two decades long career, with the best of the best in the industry. It is an irony that so many of the so called "successful professionals" take pride in sharing some seemingly strange facts. I want to reproduce a few of them as I am sure you will be able to relate with them.

*"I worked even when my kids were sick" "I attended a meeting an hour after the funeral of my dad," and some felt a sense of pride in saying that "I did not take a single holiday in the last 3 years" or "I only saw my children growing horizontally in their beds."*

The list of such "proud" expressions is endless. I never understood the logic in any of them. I don't even understand it today. I am not advocating that you be unfaithful to your company or to your work, I am only trying to say that you should keep the larger perspective in mind before taking any decision. In fact, to me, the concept of a "career" is strange – unless you are truly doing something that excites you and rejuvenates you. This, of course, was not the case around me.

My simple question to myself whenever I heard such statements, was "Are these people earning money to live a life or are they living to earn money?"

In a competitive environment where we have to depend so much on someone else's opinion about us, the whole purpose of money seems to